The Noble Averter Called the Powerful One

Āryabalavatī nāma Pratyaṅgirā · Toh 960 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཕྱིར་ཟློག་པ་སྟོབས་ལྡན་ཞེས་བྱ་བ།

The Noble Averter Called the Powerful One, known in Sanskrit as Ārya Balavatī Nāma Pratyaṅgirā, is a short protective dhāraṇī text whose Tibetan title carries the same meaning. It opens with homage to the Three Jewels and to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, praised for his great compassion and love toward all beings. It then presents an averting spell to be recited for the protection of life and vital force. The spell is said to halt harmful spirits, turn back epidemics and untimely death, overcome the malign influences of planets and lunar mansions, destroy the abodes of the māras, and subdue enemies. It is Toh 960 in the Kangyur and belongs to the class of dhāraṇī and protective incantation literature.

In the language of India: ārya balavatī nāma pratyaṅgirā
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Averter Called the Powerful One.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva, the great being, endowed with great compassion and loving toward all sentient beings.

To protect life and to protect the vital force, one should recite this averting spell. It stops all bhūtas, turns back all epidemic diseases, and turns back every untimely death. It utterly vanquishes the grahas of the planets and the lunar mansions and all the grahas of the bhūtas. It destroys every abode of the māras, and it paralyzes every enemy, one by one.

tadyathā avalokite avalokita saṃbhave dhara dhara dhara bar bar bara kāle kāle kāle mahākāla avalokita brasādāne dhame dhame dhame dhamane samāhite

Please protect me, please protect me! Please protect me from all that is fearful and terrifying! Please shelter me completely! Please hold me completely! Please guard me completely! Please bring about peace and well-being! Please avert punishment! Please avert weapons! Please seal the boundaries! Please bind the ground!

kuru kuru paṃmakṣi vidhi vidhi vidhi mārga saṃprasvate amṛtatejavati

Please protect me always from all harm, please protect me!

mulu mulu mulu khukhume ghori ghori bale bale tara tara tara muya muya muñcani khakhare dhuhūṃni dhuhūṃni

Please protect me from all fighting, quarrels, disputes, and conflicts, please protect me!

jayaṃ kuru kuru phuru phuru svāhā amale svāhā amṛte svāhā

The dhāraṇī The Noble Averter Called the Powerful One is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The word rendered "punishment" in "Please avert punishment" is the same word the glossary gives as "annihilation" in philosophical contexts. In this protective petition, set beside weapons, it plainly means punishment, such as a judicial penalty. "Averter" renders the Sanskrit pratyaṅgirā, a protective spell that repels harm.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.